NIKITA WALVEKAR

AI Project Manager | Automation & Operations Delivery

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI project manager with 9+ years delivering automation projects in banking, pricing, payroll and compliance operations for stakeholders across the US, APAC and India. Owns projects end to end: discovery, requirements, scope and schedule, RAID, vendor and engineering coordination, UAT, rollout and benefits realisation. Led GenAI initiatives at Wells Fargo from discovery to production-readiness review, including a complaint-classification project at 95% test accuracy with a USD $3M projected annual savings case. Led the SAP-to-Anaplan reconciliation automation at Diageo: AUD $12M annual value validated by finance, 60% cycle-time reduction.

CORE SKILLS

Project & Program Delivery: Project planning, scope and schedule management, requirements (BRDs, PRDs, user stories), RAID management, milestone and release planning, status and executive reporting, stakeholder management, vendor management, cross-functional and remote team coordination, change management and adoption, UAT, benefits realisation, Agile/Scrum, Jira

AI & Automation: AI and GenAI implementation projects, LLM evaluation and acceptance criteria, human-in-the-loop and escalation design, AI governance, controls and audit trails, workflow and process automation, AI-assisted documentation and reporting (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini), Lean Six Sigma DMAIC

Data & Platforms: SQL, Python (automation scripting), Power BI, Tableau, Microsoft Fabric (Azure), SAP, Anaplan, Jira, Confluence

Financial & Regulated Operations: Consumer banking operations, CFPB complaint handling, pricing operations, payroll compliance, audit controls, third-party and vendor risk, ROI and benefits measurement

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder and Principal AI Consultant | Gate 0 Consulting Studio | Bengaluru **Feb 2026 – Present**

- Scope and manage remote AI-automation projects for fintech, legal and compliance clients in India, the US and APAC: discovery, requirements, solution design, vendor and build coordination, evaluation, implementation plan and handover.
- GrowthPro AI (Apr – Jun 2026): planned and ran a 4-week delivery sprint and defined the Day-30 verification framework for an AI-search ranking product.

Senior Assistant Vice President, GenAI and Automation | Wells Fargo | Bengaluru **May 2025 – Feb 2026**

U.S. Consumer Operations

- Managed GenAI projects for U.S. Consumer Operations end to end: discovery with operations stakeholders, requirements and PRD, POC delivery, evaluation, validation and production-readiness review with risk, compliance and technology partners.
- Led the complaint-classification project to 95% test accuracy and under 2 seconds per complaint versus 3 to 5 minutes manually; built and presented the USD $3M projected annual savings case for a 160-person operations team.
- Ran per-category precision and recall testing that exposed weak results in low-volume, high-risk fraud categories; revised prompts and escalation thresholds before release sign-off, with confidence-based human review and full audit trails specified for explainability and CFPB requirements.
- Delivered the business case for a GenAI PDF-extraction project, coordinated the Microsoft Fabric (Azure) migration setup, and standardized Pre-Legal and Post-Judgment workflows across regulated jurisdictions.

Assistant Manager, Pricing and Analytics | Diageo | Bengaluru **Oct 2022 – May 2025**

- Product owner for internal pricing platforms on SAP and Anaplan across APAC and Australia: owned roadmap, backlog, release plans, dependencies and stakeholder alignment across finance, commercial and IT.
- Led a Python-based SAP-to-Anaplan reconciliation automation program through Lean Six Sigma DMAIC, delivering AUD $12M in annual value validated by finance and releasing 2 to 3 FTE from manual work.
- Delivered governed Power BI variance-control dashboards and tracked adoption and benefit realisation with finance, improving pricing accuracy and control effectiveness 35% and cutting pricing-operations cycle time 60%.
- Ran analytics delivery for a 6-member cross-regional team across time zones on Agile sprints and async documentation, improving release cadence 20%.
- Prioritized a 20+ item stakeholder backlog on an impact, effort and regulatory-risk framework, making trade-offs transparent and defensible to senior stakeholders.
- Recognized with the Johnnie Walker Blue Award (H1 FY23) and Gold Label Award (Q4 FY23) for automation impact.

Data Analyst, deputed to Diageo (pricing analytics) | VARITE India | Bengaluru **Apr 2022 – Sep 2022**

- Automated 75% of pricing workflows in Python, reducing manual effort and operational risk; converted to a permanent Assistant Manager role within 6 months.

Earlier Career | Rippling, ADP, Principal Global Services, Yardi | Bengaluru and Pune **2015 – 2021**

- PEO Operations Analyst, Rippling (Oct 2020 – Dec 2021): coordinated Workers' Compensation and Unemployment compliance processes across 50 U.S. states; automated data pipelines and BI dashboards, reducing setup and processing errors 30%.
- Senior Process Associate, ADP (Mar 2019 – Dec 2019): built Tableau payroll dashboards for 18 clients, improving payroll visibility 40% and shortening the monthly close.
- Analyst (Process Specialist), Principal Global Services (Mar 2018 – Mar 2019): built Power BI 401(k) dashboards delivering 20% error reduction and 99% on-time submissions.
- Audit and Data Operations Specialist, Yardi Software India (Jan 2015 – Feb 2018): achieved 98% audit accuracy through automated reconciliations for real-estate portfolios.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Independent projects: scoped, specified and delivered end to end (requirements, workflow design, acceptance criteria, governance rules), built with AI-assisted development. Public at github.com/walvekarn.

- Agentic AI Compliance Assistant: defined the autonomy policy for an AI compliance agent, with a 6-factor risk engine deciding when it acts, when a human reviews and when it escalates, plus a full audit trail and 8 test scenarios.
  Repository: github.com/walvekarn/agentic-compliance-agent
- Compliance Ops Toolkit: three deployed apps for third-party risk teams, each with a PRD and acceptance criteria: exception tracker with audit trail and role-based actions, vendor risk scorecard with escalation triggers, and vendor onboarding wizard with validation gates.
  Live: compliance-exception-tracker.vercel.app | vendor-risk-dashboard.vercel.app | vendor-onboard-stepper.vercel.app
- Legal PDF Extractor: document-AI pipeline extracting structured fields from court filings, specified with per-field confidence thresholds, cross-validation rules and a test suite as the acceptance gate.
  Repository: github.com/walvekarn/legal-pdf-extractor

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

- Executive Development Program, Corporate Finance and Risk Management, IIM Raipur, 2019 – 2020
- Certified Generative AI Mastermind, Outskill, 2025
- Bachelor of Commerce (Banking and Finance), Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Marathwada University, 2011 – 2014